conservative estimates place the number of migrants from Ganjam district in Surat to be over a 1,00,000. More generally, over 5 per cent of the district's population works in Gujarat. Remittances, for a while, were sent through *tappawalla*s, an informal money transfer service run by the migrants themselves, until modern methods arrived. Migration continues to be male-dominated and sub-districts of Ganjam continue to have elevated sex ratios that they experienced a 100 years before. Just like in Rangoon, the Ganjami male migrant worker continues to save on accommodation costs by sharing his room in Surat with five to ten other workers in congested housing sites.[37]

Ganjam is not the poorest part of Odisha and the households that send migrants are not the poorest households either. Migration has evolved over a century as an important response mechanism to periodic natural disasters, embedded in a cyclone-related psychology. The returns to migration have been higher than in Saran but not as high as in Udupi or Ratnagiri. Ganjam also faces an additional health hazard of HIV-AIDS linked with the promiscuity associated with mass male migration to Surat. Yet, Surat is still seen as the new 'land of gold'. As one Ganjami migrant worker explained, 'Nobody leaves the city poorer than when they first arrived.'

Ganjam's labour contribution to the economies of Burma and Gujarat has been immense. It is perhaps fitting that one of its leading contributions at the national level was also on labour issues, from a son of its soil, V.V. Giri (1894–1980), first a labour activist, then a labour minister and finally President of India. Ganjam figures today on the tourist map as a crossover point to the spectacular Chilika Lake, which hosts nearly half a million migratory birds, some who visit all the way from Siberia, during the Indian winter months. Birds or humans, the Ganjami tradition of circular migration appears to be truly all encompassing.

Clusters and Corridors along the Coasts

Ratnagiri, Udupi, Saran and Ganjam are only some of the representative districts of the Great Indian Migration Wave. I estimate that over 150 of